Logica Contra

CLEMENS THORNQUIST

Logica Contra

CLEMENS THORNQUIST

With no shirt or tie,
no brands,
no cuts indicating any creator of the moment,
stubbornly dressed in the same used-to-be-black pants,
the same worn-out t-shirts,
black sneakers and a torn smelly jersey rag,
I go around.
To place after place.
School after school.
Taking picture after picture.
Detached.
Always somewhere else.

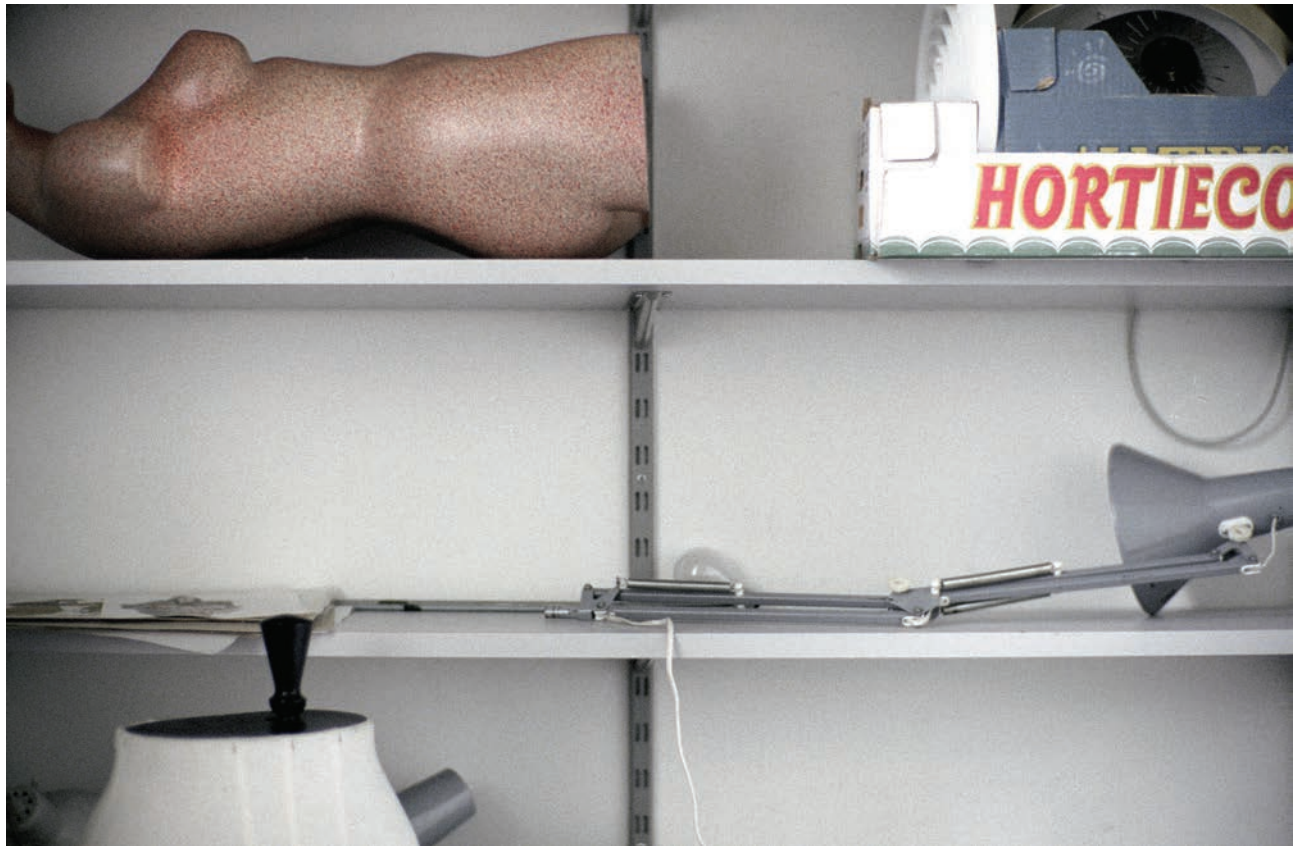
– Who?
– Where from?
– What did you want to do, you said?
– Is this part of a thesis?
– From where were you again?
– You can't just come here. We are very busy!
– We educate responsible specialist fostered by the state…
– …students that the industry likes and enjoys!
– You see, we do design, therefore we have no machines.
– Anyway, why don't you help yourself and do what it is you do…
[...while you let me return to more serious matters of
education, design and research…]





Materials


6.
VÆRKSTEDET



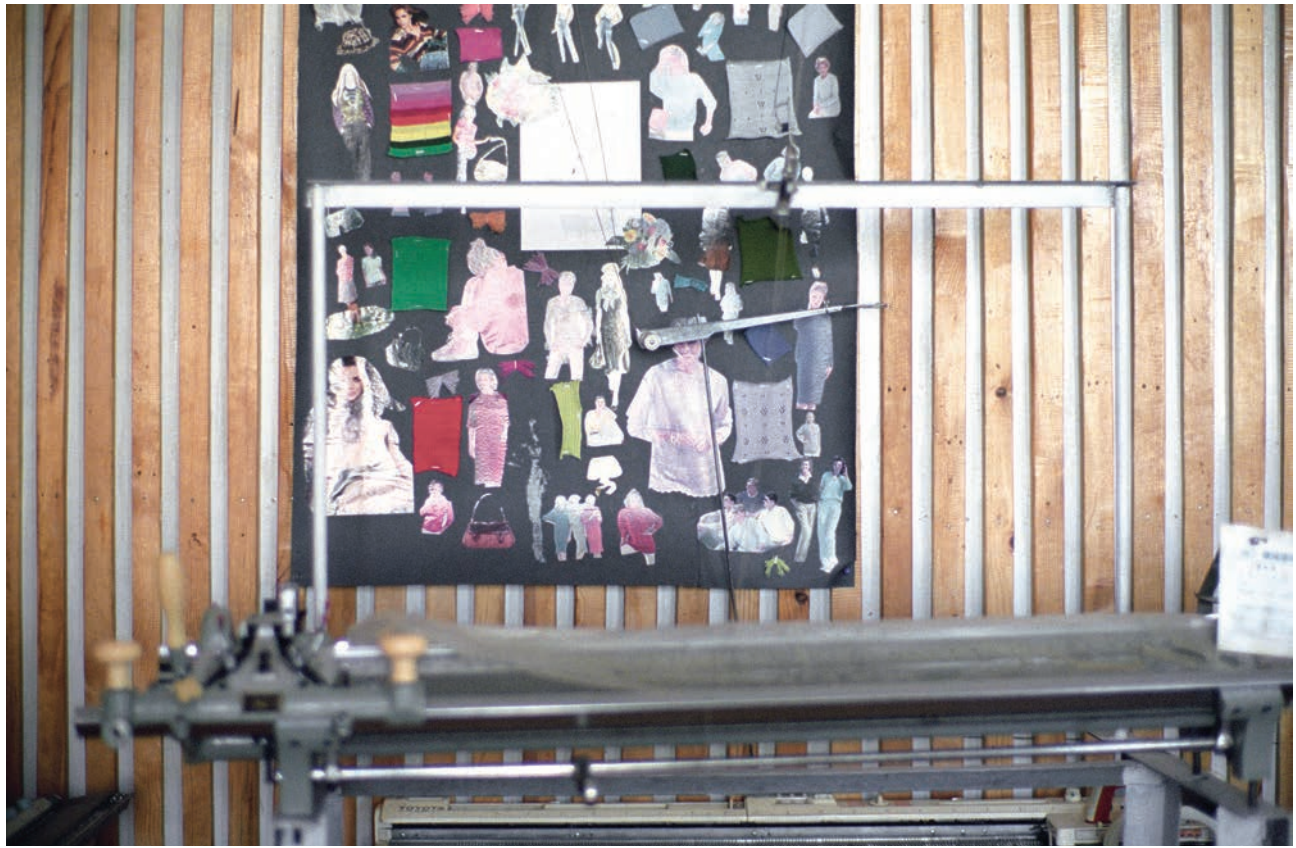
§ 03




Express Woman
UTT fashion shines
All the news that's fit to wear
Attention
Tuxedos for women
Halston's

§ 04


BAILE




Débrancher
et protéger les
machines



§ 06


march
AMBER.
HARRY WINSTON
Fashion

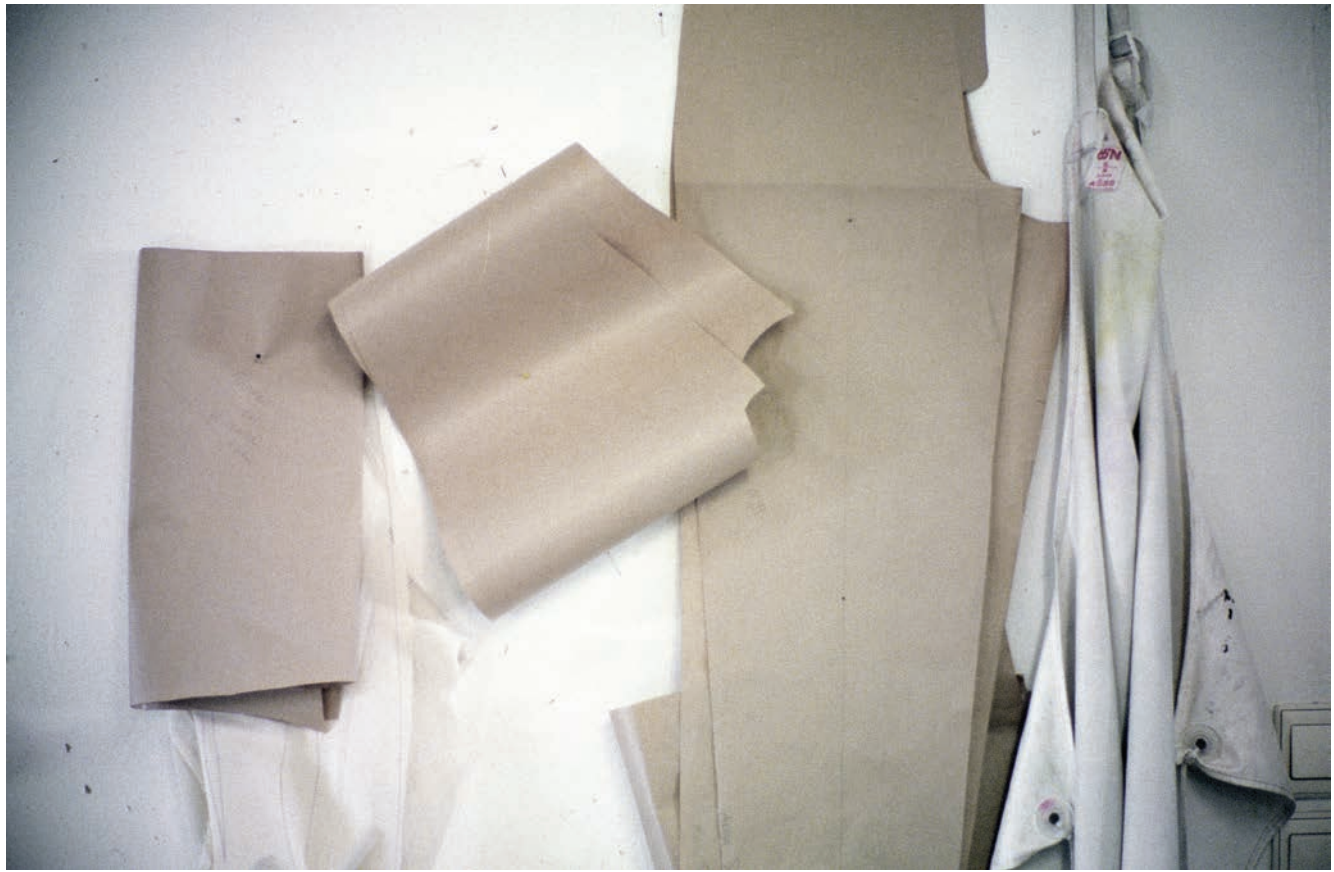



COUCH
COUCH
COUCH






Good Friday




YMSAR UPPSRRIFTIR
ELBA
RADO
ELBA
RADO
ELBA
FADO
LEITZ
LEITZ
TEXTIL












D
C
R


PFAFF
PFAFF



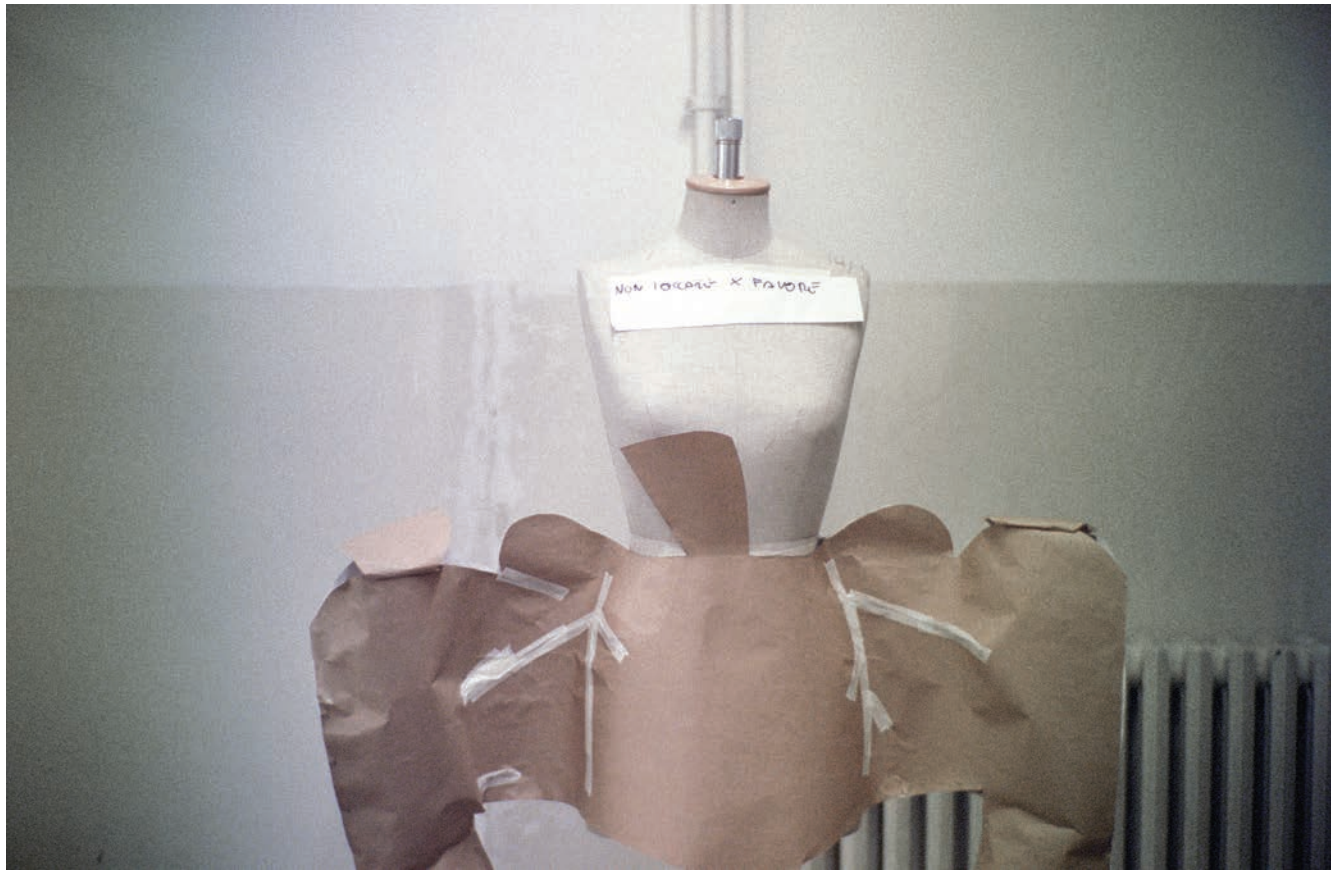









ESTINTORE


NON TOCCARE X FAVORE


Sussman


Awards/
Scholarships
Do you have what it takes
to be Canada's next
hot fashion designer?
project
RUNWAY
CANADA
FASHION ISN'T ALWAYS PRETTY.
Virtues
Vices
ONTARIO SUMMER JOBS








STOCKMANN

Modes

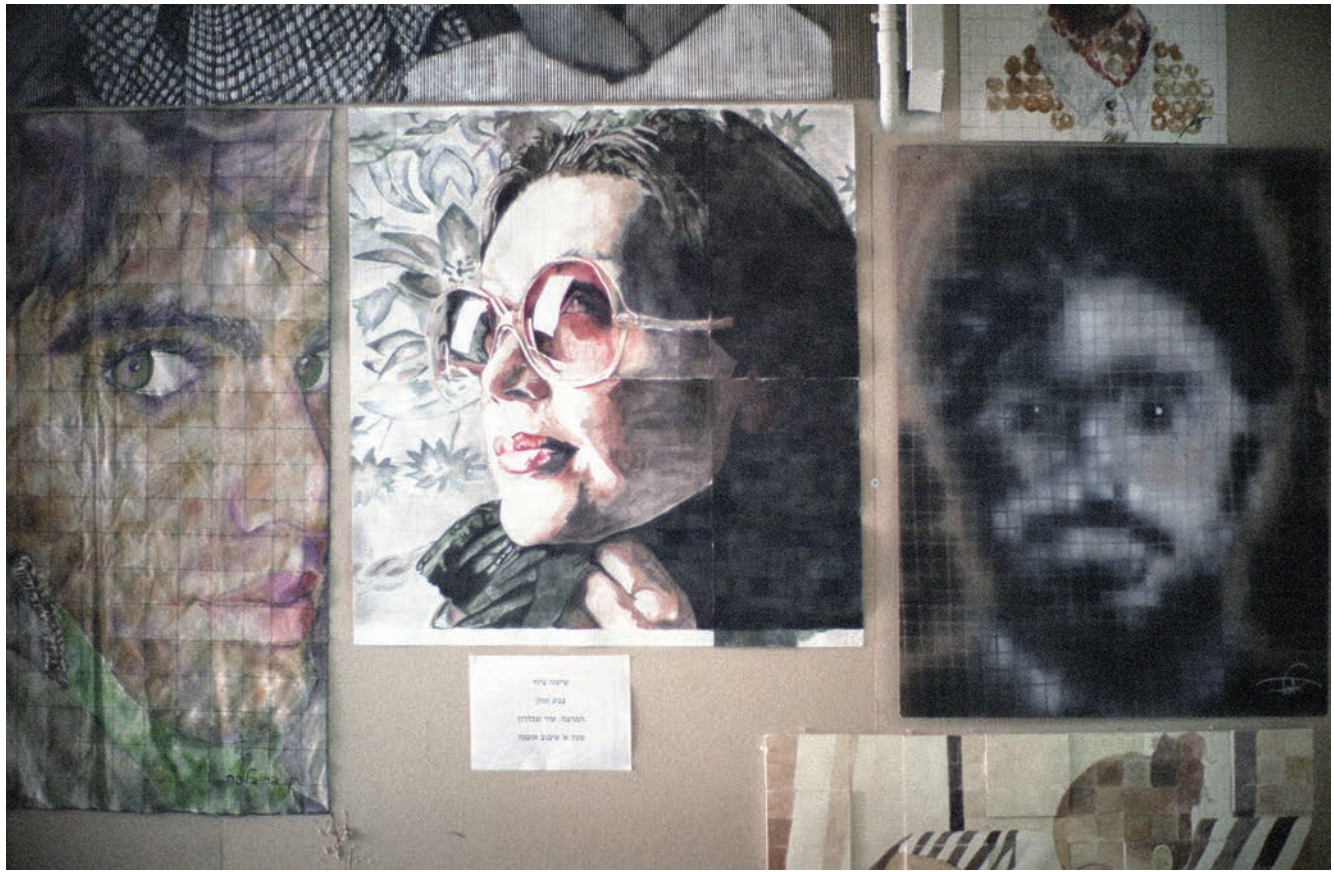

84



§ 23


PLEASE
DO NOT
TOUCH






TRAVEL
TRAVEL

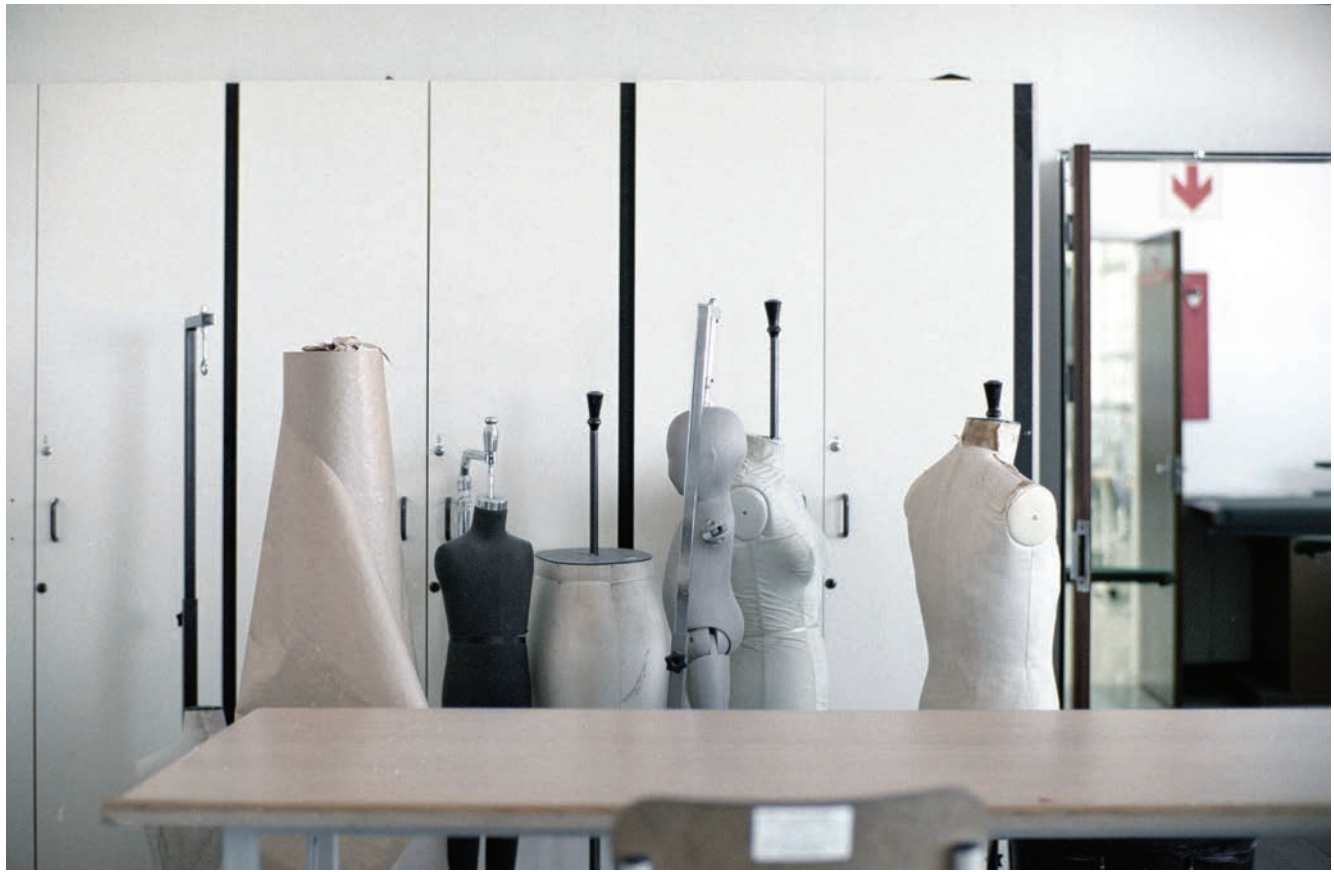









SINGER
SINGER
SINGER







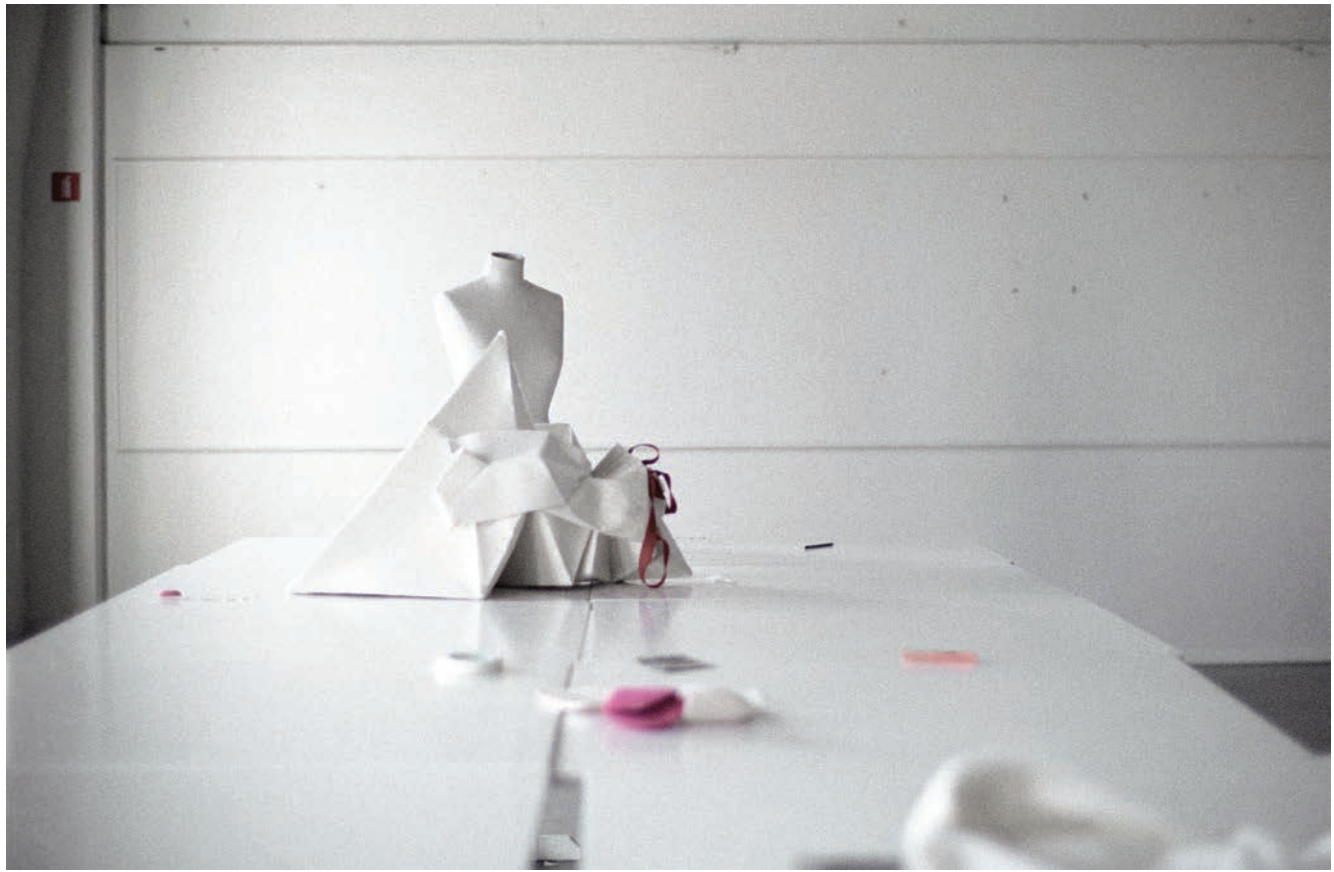

JUKI
JUKI






TECHNINĖ DOKUMENTACIJA








SIMPELT → STORT
1 → 7




SILENCE PLEASE

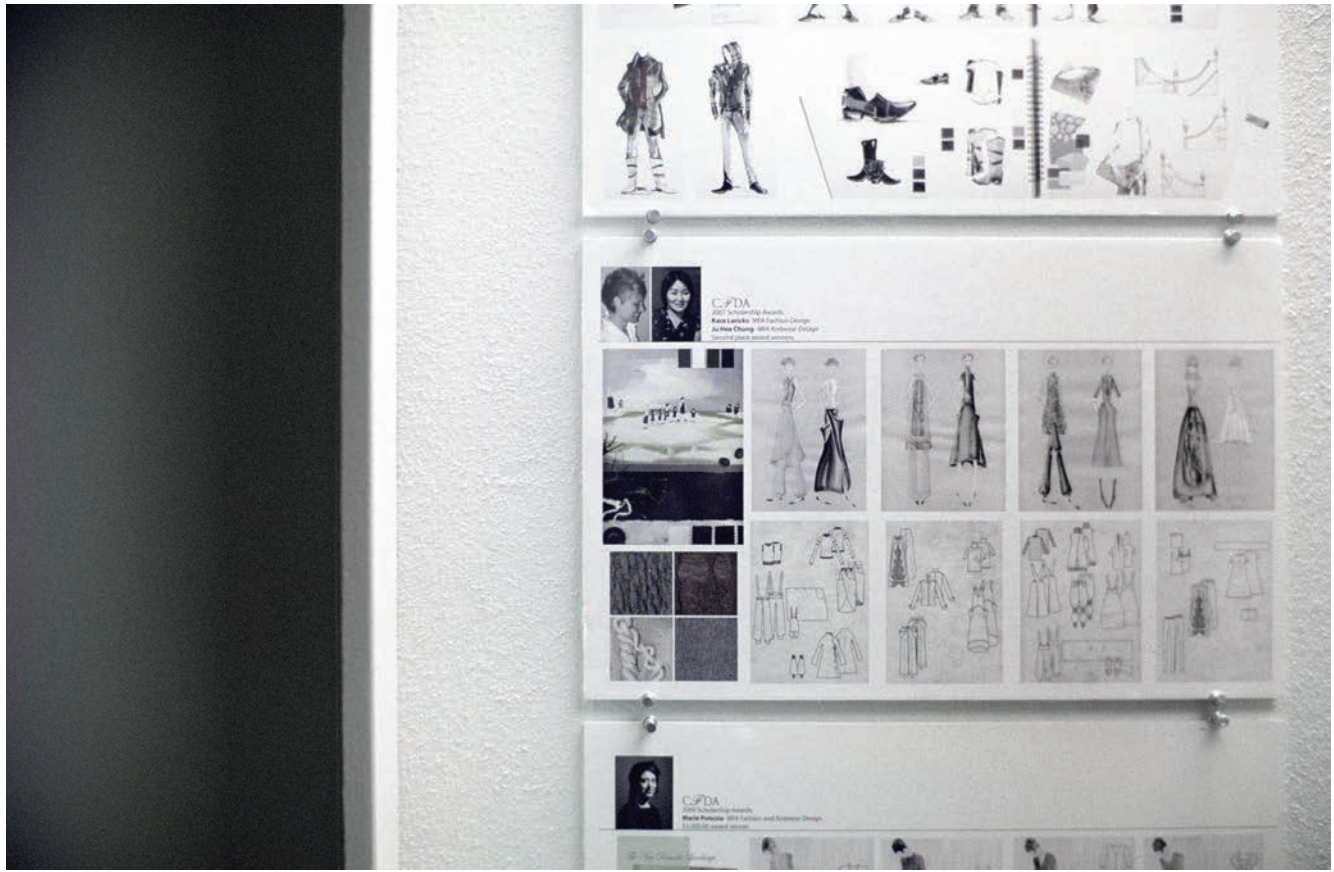

PUMP




OLGA
THE OPP SHOP
QUEEN!!

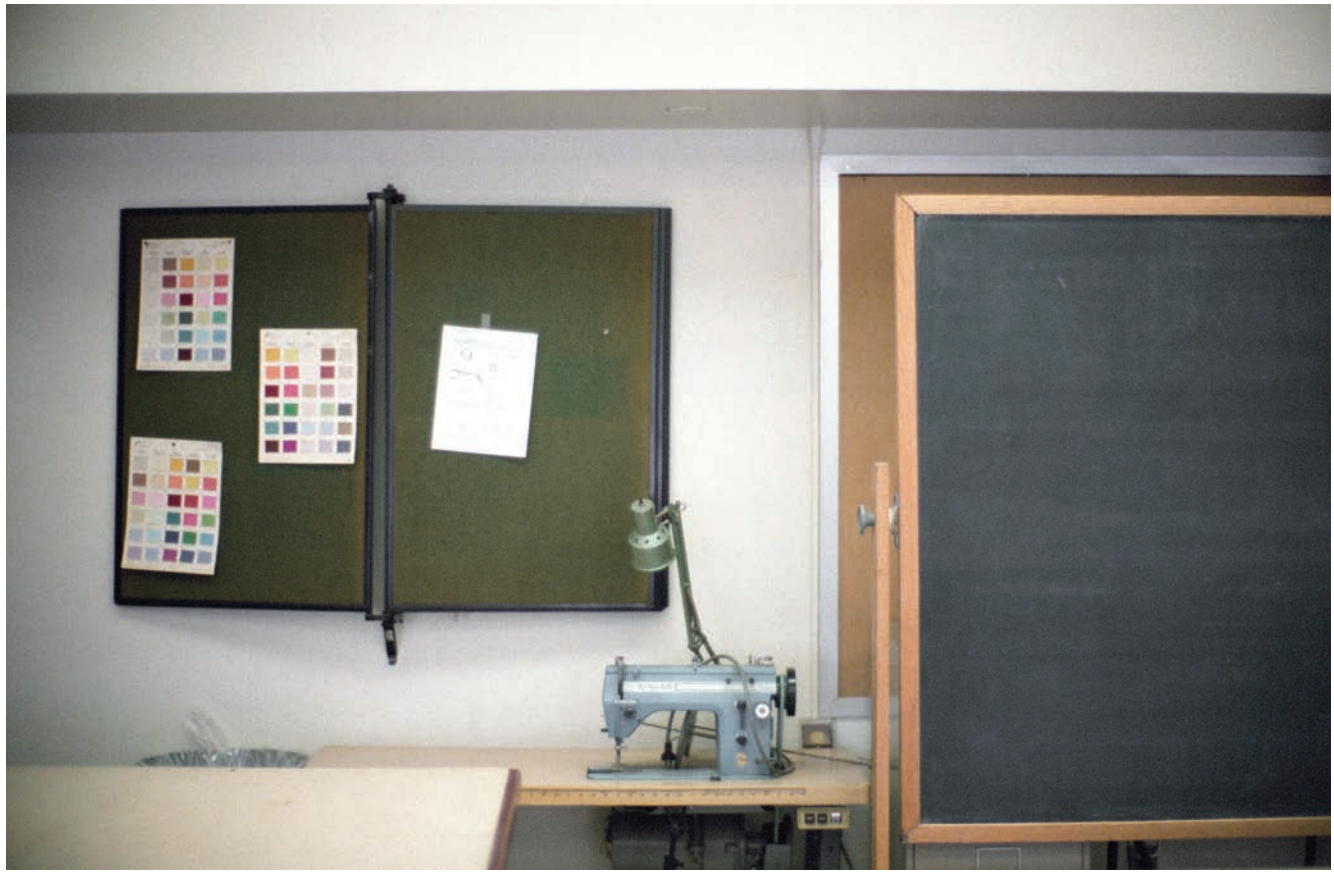


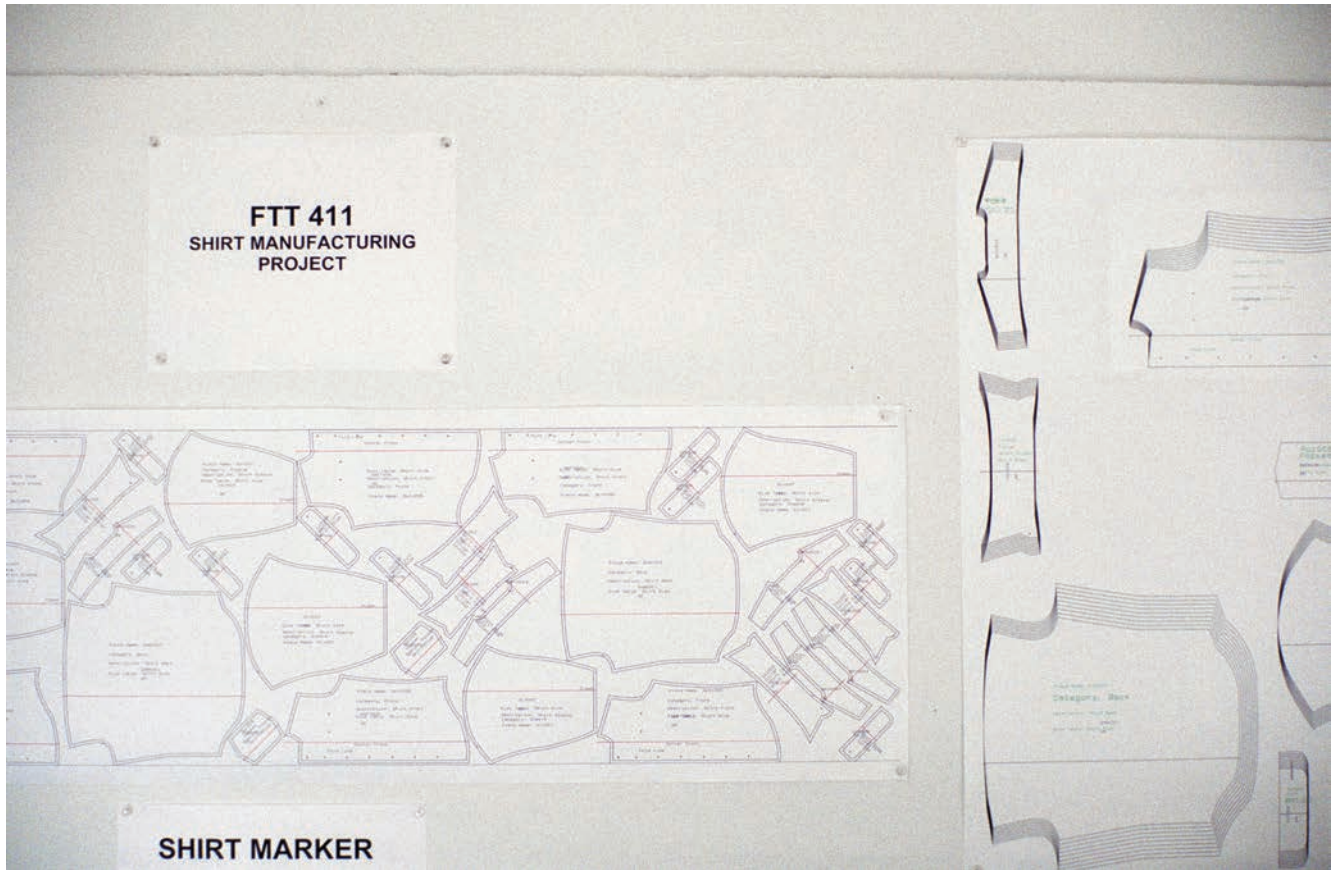

FIRST AID
Sewing Lab
Room 706
NO
ATTENTION
STUDENTS!
THIS LAB WILL
CLOSE


CFDA
CFDA

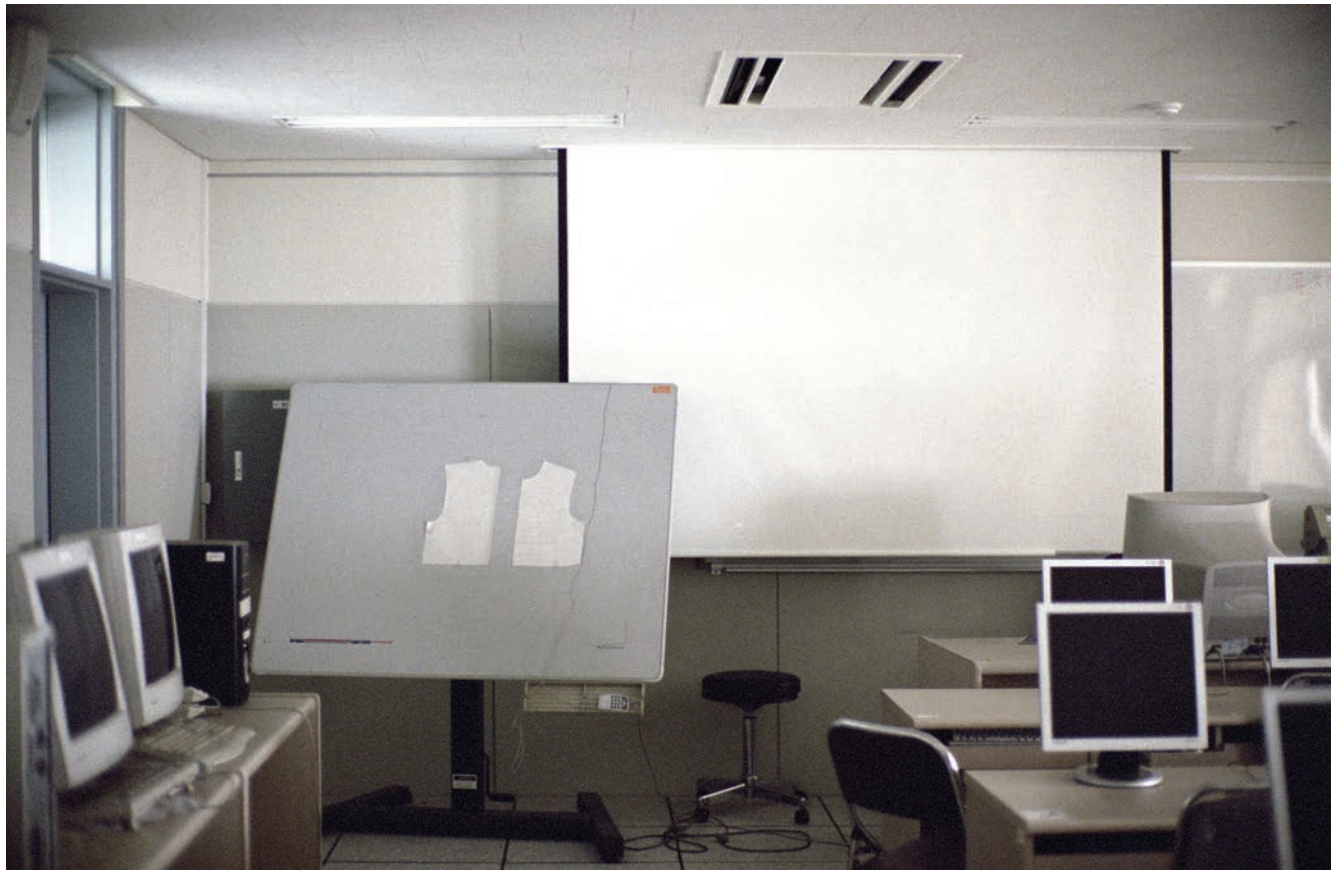

THE HISTORIANS
JOURNAL
IMPORTA
4 3 2 1
4


KL
CSM
K+L
CSM



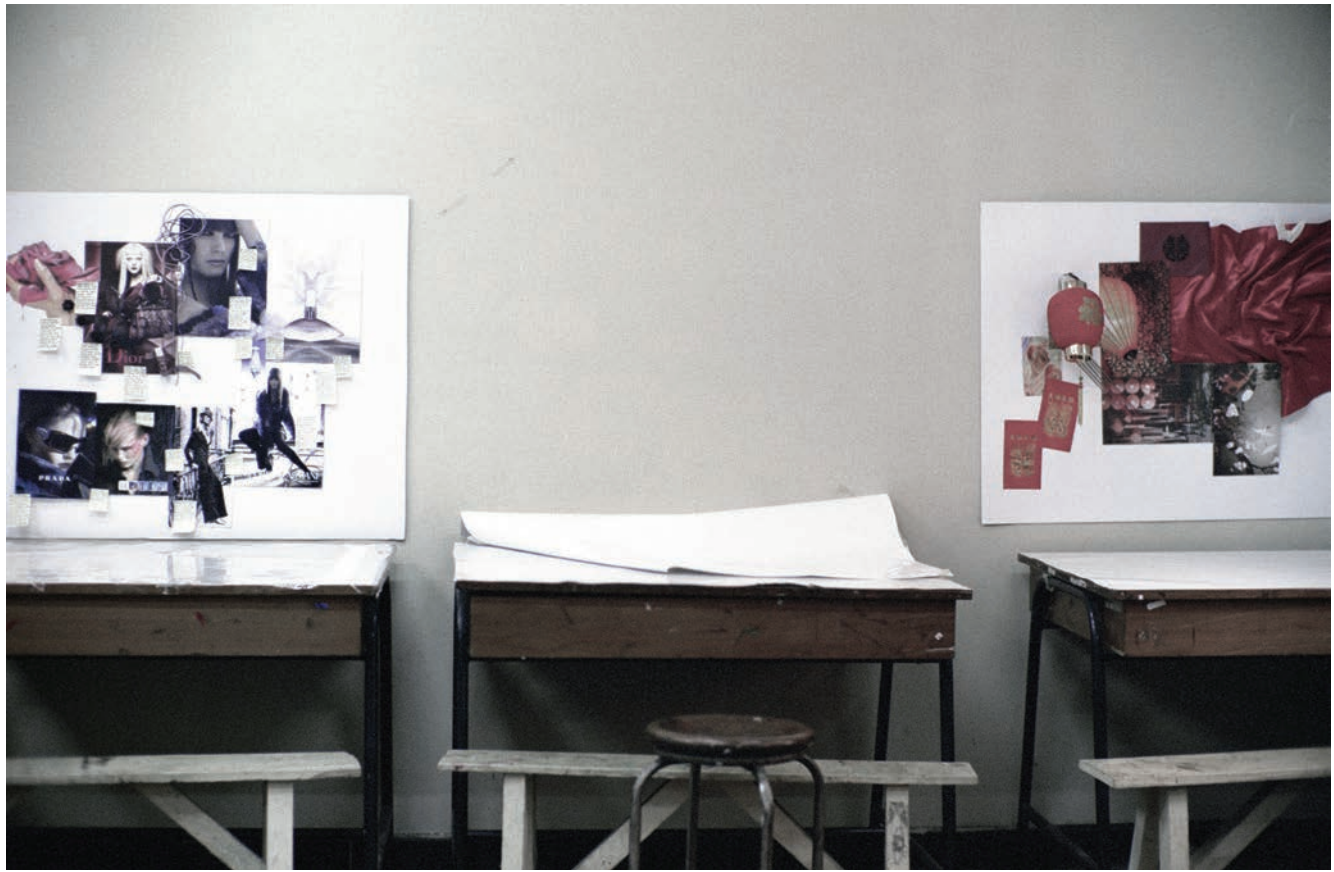

FTT 411
SHIRT MANUFACTURING
PROJECT
SHIRT MARKER

Manners



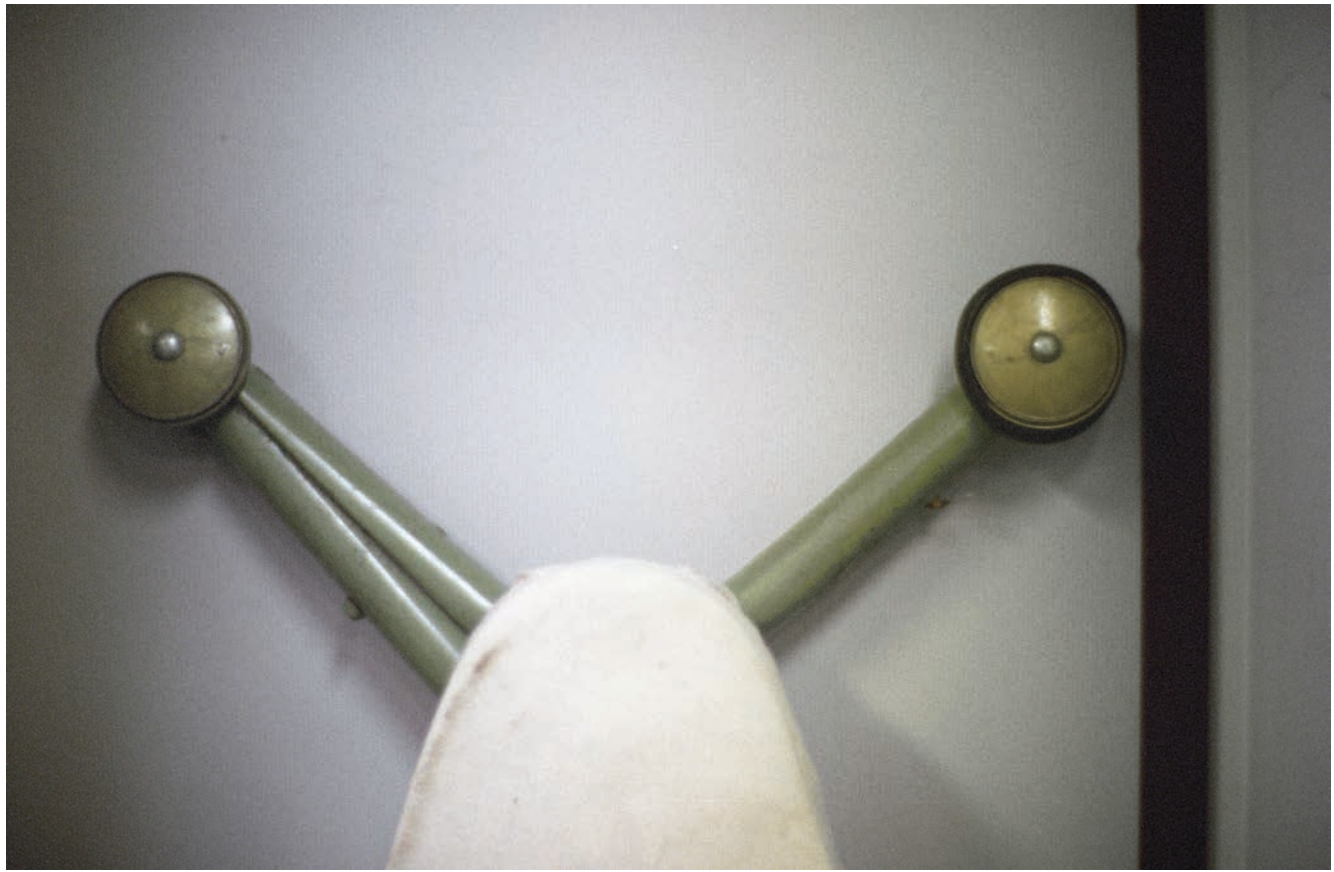

WE DO
NEED
YOU!!!!!!
第三十五屆織品服裝學系畢業動態展MODEL徵選
不限校內外!!!!!!
時間:10月8號-11月9號 中午12:00-1:30

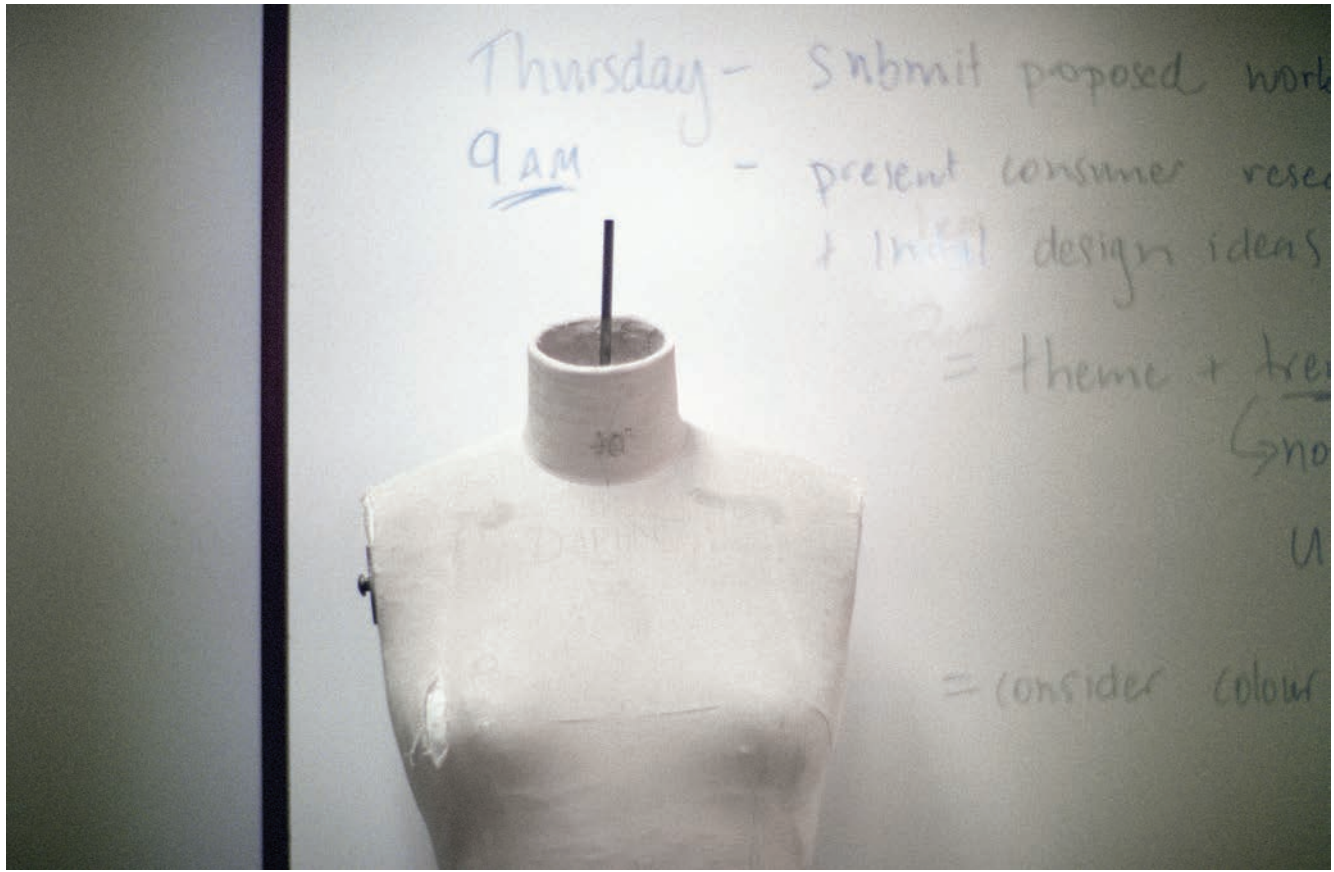



PRADA




VANIDADES
VANIDADES
NEW man




Thursday - Submit proposed work
9 AM - present consumer resea
+ initial design ideas
= theme + tre
= consider colour

Collections & Inferences


モアレ縞写真

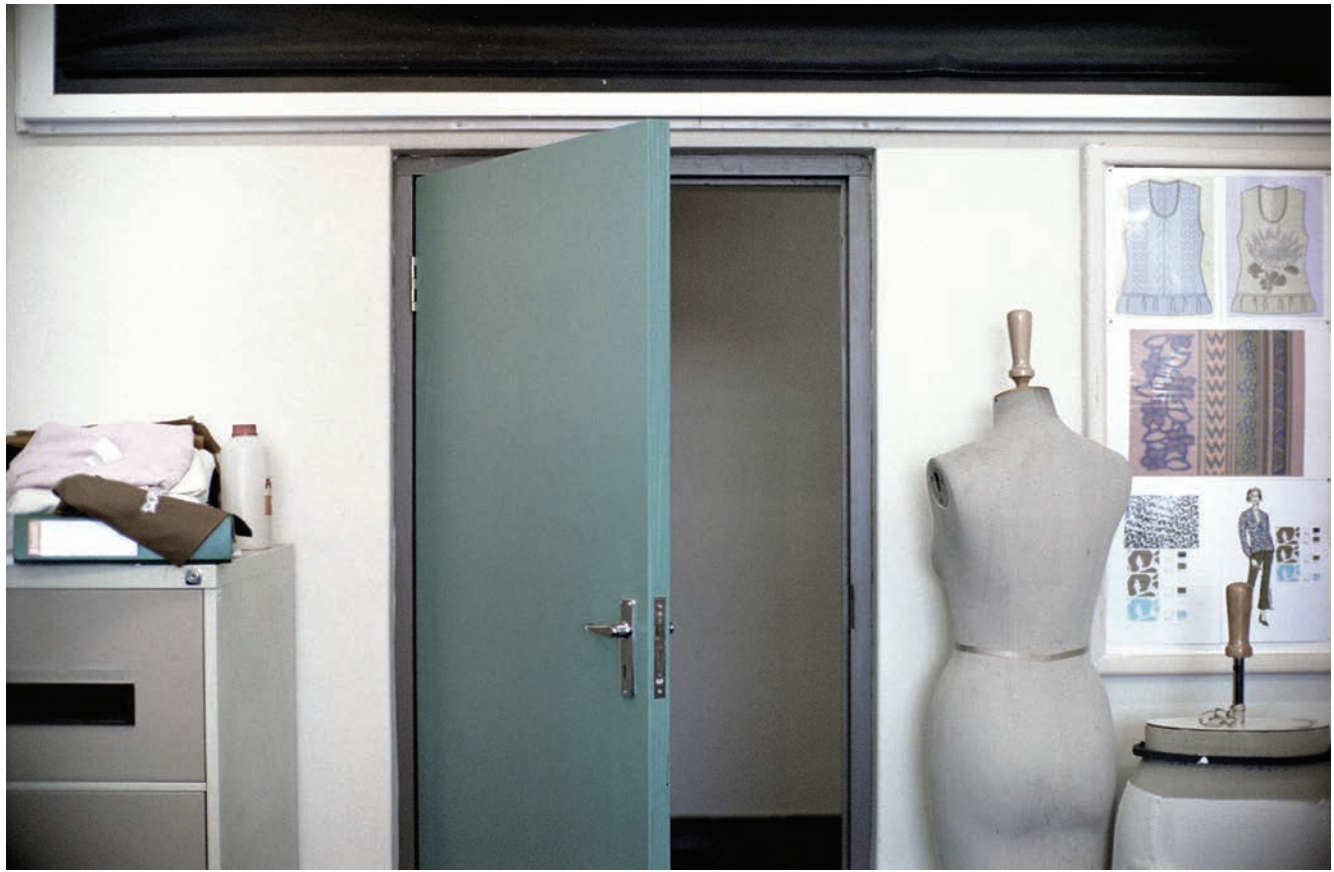

Exercice
technique
poches


MODEL 1976







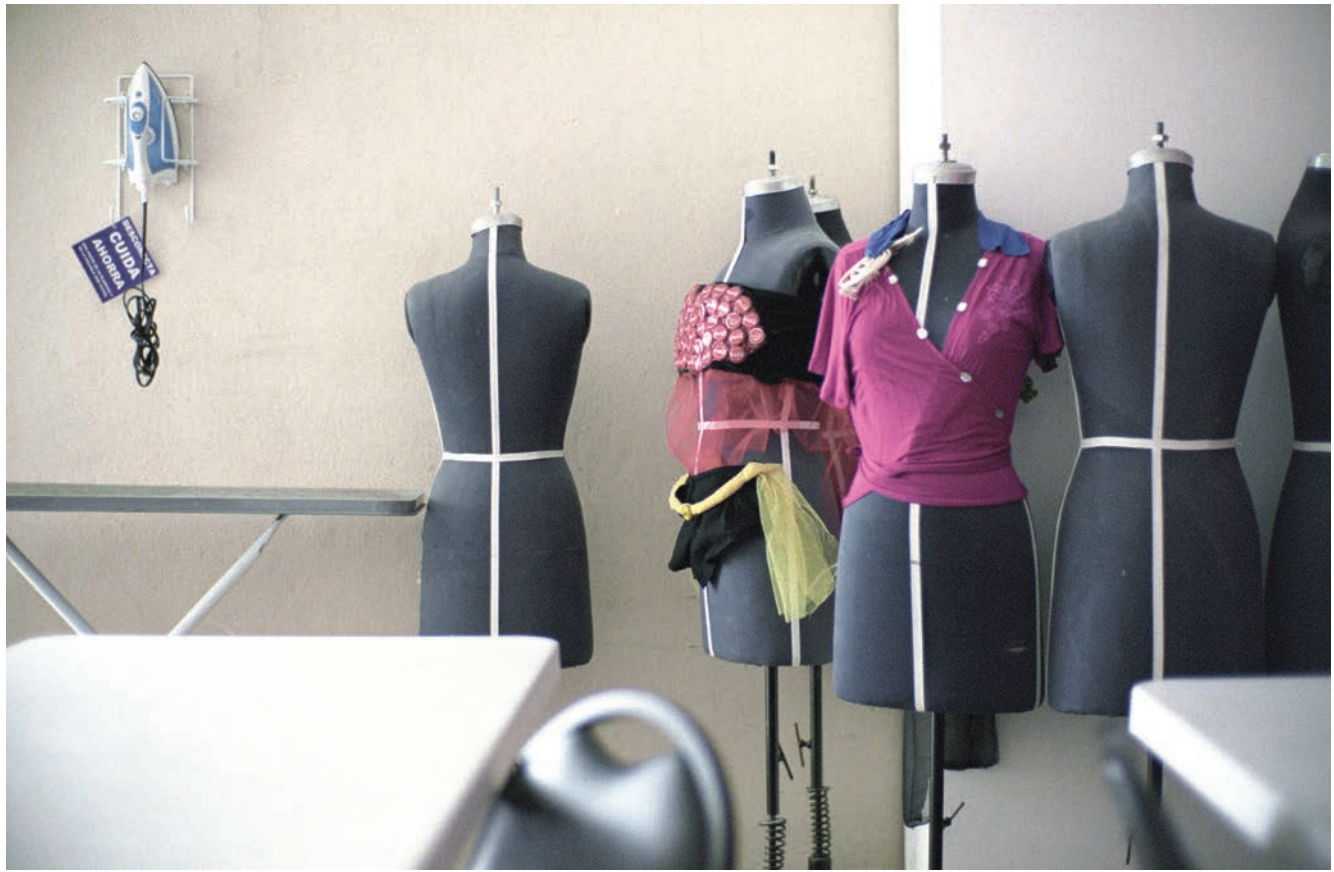



ELECTRICAL


WIN
MA
501


GIVENCHY

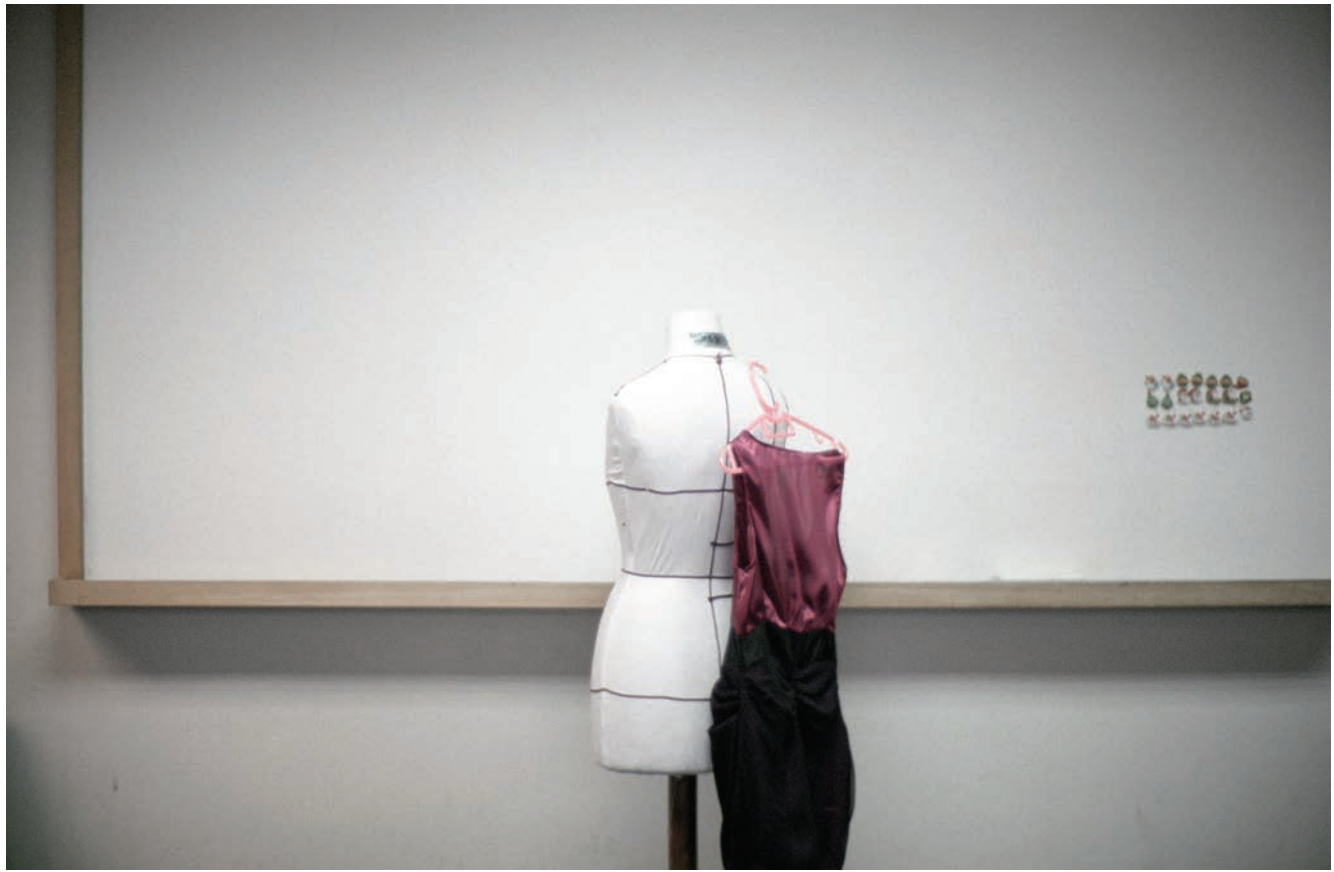



CUIDA
AHORRA


KL
KL


AHU ROOM 10
COLLAPSIBLE
MODEL 1996





Corrections.
Explanations.
Words.

Words that care little for the other.
Words that set their will against.
Words, all about themselves.

Like an anxious hostess, afraid of appearances being spoilt by overlooked trivialities and worried about what her neighbours might think, she excuses the mess and a whole plethora of other aspects, revealing a frisson of concern about what kind of image I will assign to the institute. In response, I make myself as small and as insignificant as possible so that she – the department chair, senior lecturer, director of research, president or department secretary – feels neither concerned nor guilty about not escorting me around. In my thoughts, I comfort her by judging from the academic landscape I have already seen. There is no real risk of any senseless issues being uncovered. No way of being misunderstood. No risk of losing identity. Eventually, because we share the same experiences or for reasons I can only guess, her spirit overcomes her fear and I am left with my camera in another ahistoric place of almost dystopian quality.

Considering there are but few places that induce in me such a strong sense of longing, which is perhaps more self-evident than unexpected if fashion more than anything is what Zygmunt Bauman[1] suggests: »a passion for a new beginning«, it is as universal as it is peculiar that fashion design schools are as rootless as they are. Here, at the crossroads of art, science and the humanities, fashion design schools appear at a first glance to be founded on virtually no history and share only an ornamental interest the foreign. This is what the school is associated with, regardless of academic tradition. When it comes to historical and cultural elements, these are to be found mainly in the form of different turn-of-the-century European clothing, teachings of art and design through still lifes and nudes, and varying craft techniques. However, even if bridges between past, present and future are continuing to burn, a notable academic nostalgia has begun to dredge up remains from the depths beyond the half-hearted deconstruction of modernity that the dominant discourse has had to offer. Not only is there a vast body of drapes and clothing throughout history and in different cultures that makes up a body of blunt empirical matter, but there are also critical movements elaborated within the history of clothing. As theoretical operators and models to »enter« and wear, clothes have in themselves philosophical qualities.[2] In fact, clothing in and of itself is the very theory of clothing, although unfortunately this has been confused with other academic trends such as »fashion theory« and »fashion science«, the followers of which are capable only of finding the presence of theory in words both written and spoken. And unfortunately, this graceless mistake of the current academic movements is spreading beyond their own fields into master classes in fine art and design largely because of the latter's fear of failing to behave and think like its kin, thereby enforcing a deceptive sort of scientification. Overlooking the objectification of subjectivity and thus, the fact that the difference between reflection and reaction is not in kind but degree, art programmes are being rebuilt on a textual discourse rather than continuing to develop their languages both old and new: languages without words. My point, to paraphrase Hubert Damisch and Yves-Alain Bois,[3] is that whoever criticises something should stop talking about it so much and try to do something about it. When we stop hiding behind the artificial boundary between theory and practice, empiricism and criticism, daring much more closely »zur Sache selbst«[4], things – abstract or concrete – dissolve into a permeation of each other in a universal yet particular pattern of movement. Therefore, quite frankly, clothes – different in drape, cut, line, tone and rhythm, and based on different grammar – are theories with more or less philosophical qualities, elaborated and conveyed, acted upon and reacted to. And within the history of clothing itself there exists, in and of itself, perhaps not a German idealism, but an Italian sensism, a British empiricism, a French structuralism, a Japanese elementary logic, an eclectic Belgian deconstructionist post-structuralism and why not an American analytical pragmatism, at once empirical and critical. As such, worn transcendental form makes an explicit model of the permeation of

theory and practice, in that movement becomes form in the act and form becomes movement in its acting.

Thought deprived of making.
Concept deprived of direction.
Reflection deprived of action.
Abstraction without concretion makes no vision.

In most academies I am not left alone. I am guided. Escorted kindly through more of the same in a similar landscape. This means new and refurbished buildings. Old and worn rooms accompanied by excuses or plans to move. Computer labs with more of the same graphic software. Sewing rooms with more of the same machines and mannequins. Resource centres with more of the same publications, the same editorially styled reviews. Libraries with more of the same pattern cutting books. Cabinets with more of the same pattern blocks. Chalkboards with more of the same instructions on design methodology, along with the latest technologies from Siemens, Zimmer, Minox, Juki and Weit. Together, these all make the standard models and theories of clothing design, frequently overshadowing diversity in methodology and work encouraged by different academic disciplines or traditions. Methods follow similar outlines and in the end utilise the same, or versions of the same blocks [pre-models] for patterns. What is more, and somewhat ironically, is that a field saturated with a ceaseless longing for new beginnings as its most fundamental a priori rarely seems to question where to start. Instead, it comfortably follows the »business« method of fashion design, trusting in a disillusioned hope for »inspiration«, as if this were something existing in itself, followed by »implementation« as a prophylaxis to cure the artificially forced split between vision and action.

However, for some schools this is not enough. Eagerly encouraged by both students and business partners from the »real world«, some institutes make it their mission to have the latest technology, the latest software upgrades and the latest and most widely read journals and magazines. Blinded by all the possibilities in the cry for the latest in refinement, this emphasis appears to result less in a fundamental understanding of the art of making and more in conscientious fiddling with décor, drowning in the choice of mythical references and their present seductive powers rather than making a difference through a fundamental change of direction, as even the bravest references end up in, or on, ready-made models. Through the logic of interpretation rather than establishment, the overabundance of referential décor – an *horror vacui* of plane rather than space – extinguishing the vitality of crafting as a symbol of freedom becomes more important than the freedom itself. As such, the systematic arrangement and display of ready-mades seems to define the overruling pattern of academia, overcome only sometimes by fearless endeavour seeking discovery and to establish art itself, or through the lucky circumstance whereby these ready-mades produce inter-human relations and not only represent such or even worse, merely presume to represent such according to the work manual; as promoted by Bourriaud[5] and his followers. In other words, styling with references means applying a logic different to presencing and establishing. The former is a principle, and as such a travesty of organic developments and vital relations, while the latter embodies direction and duration because of ideology and perspective.

When realised, things are particular.
When realised, things are finite.
When realised, things are infinite.
When realised, things are universal.

As if this were not enough, some schools are so anxious about their image that they clean for days before I turn up and secure clearance from the marketing department or the institute's legal advisor so as not to break with the organisational identity of the corporate school. And when I give lectures in front of students and faculty members, what I say is translated into what seems comfortable. In these places, I am certainly not served tempura cooked over the gas flames in the fibre lab. Thus it does not come as a surprise that when I want to carry on my work, I am not merely

guided. I am politely put on a leash by some kind of faculty member, two steps in front and half a step to the right of me, and a second faculty member, also of the shifting kind, two steps behind and slightly to the left. Like bodyguards, they make way and secure the area. Move things. Pick up scraps. Erase nonsense on boards. Take away students' jokes or other efforts that seem simply not to be allowed. Open doors that are already open. And keep closed doors closed, since they have already decided that what lies behind is of no importance to me.

All in all, I am served a well-structured, three-course critical discourse of a fanatically non-critical critic-ism where works are already contextualised and curated before they even get off the ground. In these rooms and among their tools and elements rests a severe, weighty spirit maintaining a deeply rooted fear of failure, masked sometimes by scepticism, sometimes by indifference. With no willingness to let one go in favour of the foreign for the initial and essential realisation of its objectives, this is a spirit that resists as it denies all possibilities outside itself according to its reasons: actors, archetypes, journals, a ten-point grading list or, simply, because it should »fit in a New York cab«. Consequently, heroic failures, miserable experiments, bizarre tests, incongruence and discords or other signs of sane or mentally subnormal activities are rarely or not to at all to be found, as my guides reveal very professionally and specifically for what they have a measure and for what not. However, this is not self-consciousness. It is a consciousness derived from pain and pleasure, hate and love. It is self-deception, referring only to principles and regulations, reasons and structures that sound all too familiar. This is not a Hegelian[6] spiritual or philosophical self-consciousness as the spirit refuses to assimilate the foreign, the outside influence, and hence is deprived of its vital self-motion. Without history and no future, no faith, no idea, no Nietzschean life-art to realise there is no self-actualisation. Here, art is what art is. Science is what science is. The humanities are what the humanities are. What is the difference?

Having moved through an academic landscape where anxiety seems to have got the better of it, I remember very well the few oases along the way that made a difference: the contemplative pace at the sanctuaries where methods, expression and motifs are found in solitude and a void imposing little, or the pulse in the Wunderkammers full of »formless« [informe[7]] remains without categorical boundaries for the »bricoleur to interrogate«.[8] The very thought of this creates a much-needed intermission before continuing in the corridors where criticism has transcended scepticism and turned into atheism, where there is a system but no ideology, where there is substance but no subject, and where the unconscious consciousness takes itself and its work so seriously that there is little or no space and time for experimental work and still less self-experimentation in the making. In such a spirit of fear of failure – thus embodying a spirit without freedom – acts cannot surpass their limits.

Unaware of its own self-shaping, moving from one identical element to another rather than from difference to difference, the spirit fails to recognise itself and its vital force in the universality of the other, atheistic monotony is the result of a system that has accomplished itself and exhausted its spiritual potential,[9] and where the only way out is a new religion: faith in a different myth, rebuilt not on the connotations of substance, but on its remains. A new »self« of substance can be realised through uncontrolled experiments with things, implying both destruction and creation of its form and meaning, and thus involving a split into individualities. In an oscillating movement, *punctus contra punctum*, much like profound irony – and by this, I do not mean a tired, post-modern critique of a distant object or a comical figure commonly accepted within a field serving merely to reinforce certain rules and knowledge, but rather irony as a quality in itself – the maker is forced in the making to enter into the dialectics of its substance and the dissolution of its own appearance. Here, ideas may become aware of themselves as particular and finite in negating their own universality and infinity, and then by sublating this negativity again restore the universal and infinite in the particular and finite.[10] At the same time, as both a self-destructing and self-inventing force, the *contrapuntal* pulse as a universal pattern of vigorous and patient experimentation joins together fragments, independent in line, rhythm and harmony, to find the greater depths of the dream from whence to build a new myth of birth.

	Art	Science	Humanities
Foundation	myth	faith	will
Motif	realise	act	translate
Material	fragments	things	images
Mode	vigour–patience	action–reaction	idea–reflection
Content	actual	evident	hypothetical
Critique	review	fit	style
Form	theoretic	possible	ornamental

§ 01 School of Fashion and Textiles, Central Saint Martins, University of the Arts London, London – December 2007
§ 02 Institute of Design, Moscow State University of Design and Technology, Moscow – April 2008
§ 03 Beklædningsdesign, Danmarks Designskole, København – September 2007
§ 04 The Caribbean Academy of Fashion and Design, University of Trinidad and Tobago, Port of Spain – May 2009
§ 05 Department of Clothing Science and Design, School of Industrial Technology and Design, Mongolian University of Science and Technology, Ulan Bator, Mongolia – March 2009
§ 06 Département Coupe, Couture et Mode, École Nationale des Arts Douta Seck, Dakar, Sénégal – March 2009
§ 07 Department of Fashion Design, Whitecliffe College of Arts and Design, Auckland, New Zealand – March 2009
§ 08 Fachhochschule Hannover, University of Applied Sciences and Arts, Fakultät III, Modedesign, Hannover – October 2007
§ 09 Faculty of Textile Science and Technology, Shinshu University, Ueda – March 2009
§ 10 Fashion Design, LaSalle College, Vancouver – March 2008
§ 11 Fatahönnun, Hönnunar- og arkitektúrdeild, Listaháskóli Íslands, Reykjavíkurborg, Lýðveldið – April 2008
§ 12 Institute of Design, Moscow State University of Design and Technology, Moscow – April 2008
§ 13 Institut für Design, Universität für angewandte Kunst, Wien – February 2008
§ 14 Institute of Textiles and Clothing, Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong – March 2009
§ 15 Instituto Superior de Diseño, Habana – March 2009
§ 16 Fashion Design, ArtEz Academie voor beeldende kunst, Arnhem – February 2007
§ 17 Mode-Design, Weißensee Kunsthochschule Berlin, Berlin – September 2007
§ 18 Oddelek za tekstilstvo, Naravoslovnotehniške fakultete, Univerze v Ljubljani, Ljubljana – September 2007
§ 19 Polimoda, Firenze – December 2008
§ 20 School of Fashion, Faculty of Communication and Design, Ryerson University, Toronto – March 2007
§ 21 The School of Art and Design, Fashion Institute of Technology, New York – March 2007
§ 22 Vaatetussuunnittelu ja pukutaide/Tekstiilitaide, Muotoilun osasto, Taideteollinen korkeakoulu, Helsinki – April 2008
§ 23 Department of Fashion Art Design, School of Fashion & Art Design, Donghua University, Shanghai – June 2007
§ 24 Department of Fashion Design, Parsons – The New School for Design, New York – March 2007
§ 25 Department of Fashion Design, Shenkar College of Engineering and Design, Ramat-Gan – May 2008
§ 26 Diseño de Modas, Nueva Escuela de Diseño y Comunicacion, Ciudad de Buenos Aires – June 2008
§ 27 Ecole de la Chambre Syndicale de la Couture Parisienne, Paris – September 2007
§ 28 Escuela Argentina de Moda, Buenos Aires – June 2008
§ 29 Faculty of Informatics and Design, Cape Peninsula University of Technology, Cape Town, South Africa – November 2007
§ 30 Faculty of Applied Arts, Mansoura University, Damietta – February 2008
§ 31 Faculty of Design, Lasalle College of the Arts, Singapore – November 2007 & March 2008
§ 32 Institut Français de la Mode, Paris – September 2007
§ 33 Kostiumo Dizaino Katedros Dėstytoja, Vilniaus Dailės Akademija, Vilnius – February 2007
§ 34 Mode, Artesis Hogeschool Antwerpen, Koninklijke Academie voor Schone Kunsten, Antwerpen – January 2009
§ 35 Mode, Beckmans Designhögskolan, Stockholm – May 2008
§ 36 Modedesign, Textilhögskolan, Högskolan i Borås, Borås – May 2009
§ 37 Pearl Academy of Fashion, New Delhi – October 2008
§ 38 School of Art and Design, Faculty of Design and Creative Technologies, Auckland University of Technology, Auckland – March 2009
§ 39 School of Design, Otago Polytechnic, Dunedin – March 2009
§ 40 School of Fashion, Academy of Art University, San Francisco – November 2007
§ 41 School of Fashion and Textiles, Central Saint Martins, University of the Arts London, London – December 2007
§ 42 Technology Department, Buffalo State College, Buffalo – March 2007
§ 43 Department of Fashion Design and Textiles, College of Human Ecology, INHA University, Incheon – November 2007
§ 44 Department of Textiles and Clothing, Human Ecology College, Fu Jen Catholic University, Taipei – November 2007
§ 45 Faisalabad Institute of Textile & Fashion Design, Faisalabad – April 2008
§ 46 Fakultas Seni Rupa dan Desain, Institut Teknologi, Kota Bandung – November 2007
§ 47 Future Excellence Design Institute of South Africa, Cape Town – November 2007
§ 48 Pearl Fashion Institute, Dhaka, Bangladesh – November 2007
§ 49 School of Fashion and Textiles, Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology, Melbourne – March 2008
§ 50 Division of Fashion Creation, Bunka Fashion College/ Bunka Fashion Graduate University, Tokyo – June 2007
§ 51 Département Coupe, Couture et Mode, École Nationale des Arts Douta Seck, Dakar – March 2009
§ 52 The School of Art and Design, Fashion Institute of Technology, New York – March 2007
§ 53 Diseño de Modas, Nueva Escuela de Diseño y Comunicacion, Ciudad de Buenos Aires – June 2008
§ 54 Escuela de Diseño, Facultad de Comunicación y Diseño, Universidad Ort, Montevideo – June 2008
§ 55 Evelyn College of Design, Nairobi – October 2008
§ 56 Faculty of Informatics and Design, Cape Peninsula University of Technology, Cape Town – November 2007
§ 57 Fashion Design Studio, TAFE NSW Sydney Institute, Sydney – March 2008
§ 58 Fashion Design Technology, London College of Fashion, University of the Arts London, London – December 2008
§ 59 French Fashion University Esmod, Dubai – February 2008
§ 60 Institute of Textiles and Clothing, Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong – March 2009
§ 61 Instituto Trozmer de Diseño e Imagen, Cancún – March 2009
§ 62 Istanbul Moda Akademisi, İstanbul – February 2008
§ 63 National Institute of Fashion Technology, New Delhi – October 2008
§ 64 Professionalnyj Texhnitjeskij Kolledzj, Minsk – May 2007
§ 65 Temasek Design School, Temasek Polytechnic, Singapore – March 2008

1. Zygmunt Bauman (2006, March) *Lecture*, Växjö University, Sweden.
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9. Spengler, O. (1918/1926) *The decline of the West. Vol. 1, Form and actuality*. New York: Knopf.
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Logica Contra

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